

BROWSER PROTECTION

Your browsing activity and the configuration you have selected can, to a large extent, define the security levels that you enjoy. Configure it right for safe surfing

Internet Explorer 5 and 5.5

Internet Explorer is the most popular browser and therefore majority of the exploits are targetted towards it. So, you definitely need to be more cautious

Deleting cookies

Many Web sites drop little files onto your system that let them keep track of your passwords, and the date and time of your visits. To get rid of these files, delete the contents of the Cookies folder and the Temporary Internet Files folder in your Windows directory (but not the folders themselves). This will remove all traces of your surfing pattern. You could also use a third-party cookie cleaning software such as Cookie Crusher.

Working around cookies

Adjust IE's security settings to keep random Web sites from sending cookies to your hard drive or uploading ActiveX Controls. To do this, select Internet Options from the Tools menu, and click on the Security tab. Slide the bar under 'Security level for this zone' up or down to increase or decrease the security level. Each level (High, Medium, Medium-Low, and Low) lists exactly which

actions and applications it allows or blocks. It is better to click Custom Levels, and then select to prompt for cookies that are stored on your computer and per-session cookies. This allows you to control which sites you want to allow cookies. Remember though, that some sites may not work properly if cookies is disabled. In addition to this, you should also disable ActiveX, since this can pose a serious security hazard.

Disabling Windows Scripting Host

Internet Explorer installs Windows Scripting Host by default, and this is used to run VB scripts that may contain viruses or Trojans. To remove Windows Scripting Host, go to Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs > Windows Setup. Select Accessories and from there uncheck Windows Scripting Host. You can also go to the Folder Options in Windows Explorer, and select the .vbs file type and remove it.

Disabling AutoComplete

The AutoComplete feature may be useful while filling out forms and usernames, but it also allows other users to know your username and then probably

guess your passwords. When the Auto-Complete function is active, some sites, search engines and entry fields retain the words you've entered, so anyone who uses the browser after you and visits that site can see the entries you made.

To turn off this feature, in the Internet Options dialog box, click the Content tab. Next, click the AutoComplete button in the Personal Information section to display the AutoComplete Settings window. Uncheck the 'Forms' and 'Usernames and Passwords on Forms' boxes.

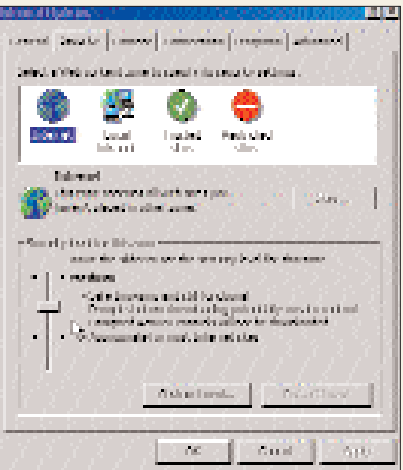
Deleting History items

The History folder stores a record of all the Web sites you've visited. This is very convenient, but then your boss, friend, or colleague can easily find out what you've been surfing. Here's what you can do to get rid of unwanted URL histories: in Internet Options under the General tab, find the History section and click the Clear History button. Repeat this before you close the browser. Set the 'Days to keep pages in History' to 1. This will not only keep IE neat and tidy, but will also act as a cushion if you forget to clear.

If you don't want to clear your entire History folder, you can choose to remove single pages. To do this, click the History button on your IE toolbar to open the History window frame. Right-click on the file you want to dump and select Delete from the pop-up window.

Filtering content

Certain sites on the Internet are certainly not appropriate for children. You can use a separate software program for filtering content, but IE also has some built-in filtering tools. To configure these, click the Content tab from Internet Options. Next, click the Enable button under Content Advisor and adjust the slider in each of the four categories:



Adjust security settings to block cookies



Tame Auto-Complete to ensure privacy

Ad will come